

HIST 214: The Atlantic World, 1450–1850

Fall 2026 — Prof. Daniel Okafor — okafor@ridgeline.edu

We meet Tuesdays and Thursdays from 1:00 to 2:15 PM in Merrill Hall 12. My office hours are Wednesdays 2:00–4:00 PM in Merrill 305, or by appointment. The semester runs from Tuesday, August 25 through Thursday, December 10, 2026.

About the Course

This seminar traces the movement of people, goods, and ideas across the Atlantic basin from first contact through the age of revolutions. We will read primary sources alongside recent scholarship, and much of our class time will be devoted to discussion, so come prepared to talk.

Assignments and Grading

Your grade rests on three response papers (10% each), a midterm essay worth 20%, one in-class presentation worth 10%, class participation (10%), and a final essay worth 30%. There are no exams in this course.

The first response paper is due Friday, September 18. The second is due Friday, October 9, and the third is due Friday, November 13. Response papers should be submitted by email before midnight on the day they are due, and should engage closely with that week's primary sources.

The midterm essay (five to seven pages) is due at the start of class on Thursday, October 22. I will circulate a list of prompts two weeks beforehand; you are also welcome to propose your own topic in office hours.

Presentations will take place in class on Tuesday, December 1. Each student will present one week's readings to the seminar and lead the opening fifteen minutes of discussion. A sign-up sheet will circulate in September.

Final essay: date TBA. The final-essay deadline will be announced once the registrar releases the December exam schedule; it will fall during finals week. The essay should be ten to twelve pages and may build on your midterm essay with my permission.

Policies

Extensions are granted freely if requested at least 48 hours in advance, and almost never afterwards. Please bring the assigned reading to every meeting; laptops are welcome for notes and sources only.